

Dog Bites in Worland

What the city code requires after a dog bites someone — the ten-day rule, who decides where the dog waits it out, and what else a bite sets in motion.

THE RULE

“Any dog that has bitten any person shall be confined under the observation of a licensed veterinarian for a period of ten days, after the attack, at the expense of the owner, to determine whether the animal has any disease which may be communicated to humans. Home quarantine may be allowed, as determined by and at the discretion of the Animal Control Officer or Peace Officer.”

SEC. 4-25 • CONFINEMENT OF DOGS THAT HAVE BITTEN PERSONS

THE TWO CLOCKS

10

DAYS • OBSERVATION

Counted from the attack, not from the report or the impoundment.

3

DAYS • REDEMPTION

If the dog is impounded, this is all the time there is to claim it. After that it is destroyed.

WHAT HAPPENS, IN ORDER

01 The bite.

The ten days run from the attack itself. Nothing in the section says who must report it or to whom. [4-25]

- 02

Observation begins.

The dog is confined under a licensed veterinarian’s observation, to establish whether it carries a disease communicable to humans. [\[4-25\]](#)
- 03

Where it waits.

A clinic by default, at the owner’s expense. Home quarantine is possible, but only if the Animal Control Officer or a Peace Officer allows it — it is discretionary, and the owner is not entitled to it. [\[4-25\]](#)
- 04

The bill.

The owner pays throughout — the veterinarian’s observation, and, if the dog was impounded, a **\$50** redemption fee to the City Treasurer plus the daily boarding charge. [\[4-1-3\]](#)

WHAT A BITE ALSO SETS IN MOTION

A vicious-dog charge 4-15 A dog that is notoriously vicious or cross, or that shows a disposition to bite, must be both secured <i>and</i> muzzled. On conviction the municipal judge may order a police officer to have the dog killed, and officers may enter the premises to do it.	A nuisance count 4-7-2 · 4-7-3 Molesting people is itself a public nuisance. Three violations makes the dog a <i>habitual</i> public nuisance, and the court then requires it destroyed or moved outside city limits within ten days.
Proof of rabies vaccination 4-17 · 4-24 Keeping an unvaccinated dog is unlawful, and a dog without current licence and vaccination tags may be impounded — three days, then destroyed.	The licence check 4-26 Every dog five months or older must be licensed each year and wear the tag. A lapsed licence turns one incident into two offences.

WHAT CHANGED IN 2025

ORDINANCE NO. 879 · ADOPTED 6 MAY 2025 · EFFECTIVE 17 MAY 2025

The section had stood unchanged since 1951. Ordinance 879 amended it without striking a single word — every clause below was added to the original text.

- + **“after the attack”** — fixes when the ten days begin. Previously unstated, so the count could be argued from impoundment instead.
- + **The purpose clause** — communicable-disease observation is now written into the section rather than merely understood.
- + **Home quarantine** — the substantive change. Before this, a clinic was the only lawful place to serve the ten days.

TWO THINGS THE CODE DOES NOT SAY

- ? **No appeal is written in.** If the officer declines home quarantine, Sec. 4-25 provides no route to contest it. Compare the chicken permits at Sec. 4-30, which set out a full written appeal to the City Council.
- ? **Cats are governed differently.** Ordinance 879 amended only the dog section. The cat provision, Sec. 4-12, remains in its bare 1951 form — no home quarantine, no stated purpose, no “after the attack.”

This is a plain-language summary of municipal code, not legal advice. Sec. 4-25 is the most recently amended provision in the chapter, so practice may run ahead of the printed text — confirm anything load-bearing with the Worland City Clerk.

Source: Municode Library, City of Worland Code of Ordinances, Chapter 4 — Animals and Fowl, and Ordinance No. 879 as adopted. Prepared 22 August 2026.